MAKI Cheat Sheet

Media Asset Keeper & Indexer — v4.12.2

Global Options

`--json`	JSON output to stdout
`-v, --verbose`	Show operational details
`-l, --log`	Per-file progress to stderr
`-d, --debug`	External tool debug output
`-t, --time`	Show elapsed time

Setup

maki init
Create a new catalog in the current directory.

maki volume add *[LABEL] PATH*
Register a storage volume (label auto-derived from path if omitted).
`--purpose media|working|archive|backup|cloud`

maki volume list
Show registered volumes with online/offline status.
`--purpose PURPOSE --offline --online`

maki volume set-purpose / rename / remove
Change purpose, rename, or unregister a volume.

maki volume combine / split
Merge two volumes or split a subdirectory into new volume.

Ingest & Edit

maki import *PATHS...*
Import files into the catalog.
`--volume --profile NAME --auto-group --smart`
`--embed` [Pro] `--describe` [Pro] `--dry-run`
`--include GROUP --skip GROUP`

maki watch *[PATHS...]*
Poll directories and auto-import new files. `--volume --interval SECS --once`

maki delete *ASSET_IDS...*
Delete assets. `--apply --remove-files --no-trash`

maki tag *ASSET_ID TAGS...*
Add or remove tags. `--remove`

maki tag rename *OLD NEW*
Rename a tag across all assets. `--apply`
OLD accepts **=** (exact level) and **^** (case-sensitive) prefixes.

maki tag delete *TAG*
Delete a tag (cascades to descendants) from every asset. `--apply`
TAG accepts the same **=** / **^** markers as **tag rename**.

maki tag split *OLD NEW...*
Replace one leaf tag by two or more tags. `--keep --apply`

maki tag scan / expand-ancestors *[QUERY]*
Report malformed tags (read-only); add missing ancestor levels. `--asset --apply`

maki tag clear *ASSET_ID*
Remove all tags from an asset. `--source SRC`

maki tag fix-unicode
NFC-normalise every tag value catalog-wide; merges NFC/NFD duplicates per asset. `--apply`

maki tag export-vocabulary
Export tag tree as vocabulary.yaml.
`--prune --default --output FILE --counts`
`--format yaml|text|json` (text = tab-indented for Lightroom / Capture One; json = nested objects for scripts; `--counts` adds '# N assets' trailing YAML comments)

maki edit *ASSET_ID*
Edit metadata fields.
`--name --description --rating N`
`--label COLOR --date --clear-FIELD`

maki group *HASHES...*
Group variants into one asset.

maki split *ASSET_ID HASHES...*
Split variants out of an asset.

maki auto-group *[QUERY]*
Auto-group by filename stem (directory-local). `--apply --global`

maki describe *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Generate VLM image descriptions.
`--asset ID --volume --model`
`--mode describe|tags|both`
`--apply --force --dry-run`

maki auto-tag *[QUERY]* [Pro]
AI auto-tagging with SigLIP.
`--asset --volume --threshold`
`--labels FILE --apply --download`

maki embed *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Generate image embeddings.
`--asset --volume --force --export`

maki auto-stack *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Cluster visually similar assets into stacks.
`--threshold PCT --min-size N --apply`

maki ai export-vocabulary [Pro]
Dump the active AI label vocabulary as YAML. `--default -o FILE`

maki audio analyze *[QUERY]*
Detect musical key / BPM via external tools. `--force --dry-run`

Retrieve

maki search *QUERY*
Search assets with filters (see back).
`--format ids|short|full|json|{template}`
`-q` (shorthand for **--format ids**)

maki show *ASSET_ID*
Show full asset details.

maki preview *ASSET_ID*
Open preview in OS default image viewer.

maki export *QUERY TARGET*
Export to directory. `--zip --layout flat|mirror`
`--all-variants --include-sidecars`

maki contact-sheet *QUERY OUTPUT*
Generate PDF contact sheet.
`--layout --paper --landscape`
`--title --fields --sort`

maki duplicates
Find duplicate files. `--same-volume --cross-volume --volume --format`

maki stats
Catalog statistics breakdown. `--tags --verified`

maki status
Health overview with next-step hints. `--min-copies N`

maki backup-status
Show backup coverage and at-risk assets. `--at-risk --min-copies N`

maki doc *[manual|cheatsheet|filters|tagging]*
Open documentation PDF in browser.

maki licenses
Show MAKI license + 3rd-party crate licenses. `--summary`

maki serve
Start web UI. `--port --bind --read-only`

maki shell *[SCRIPT]*
Interactive shell, or run a script file. `-c CMD --strict`

Maintain

maki undo / history *[ASSET_ID]*
Revert the latest metadata edit; list recent edits. `--dry-run --force`
`--limit N`

maki doctor
Check YAML sidecars against the SQLite catalog. `--sample N --repair`

maki verify *[PATHS...]*
Check file integrity.
`--volume --asset --force --max-age DAYS`

maki sync *PATHS...*
Sync with disk changes. `--apply --remove-stale`

maki sync-metadata *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Bidirectional XMP sync. `--volume --asset --media --dry-run`

maki refresh *[PATHS...]*
Re-read changed recipes. `--dry-run --media`
`--reimport` — full re-extract `--exif-only` — EXIF only

maki writeback *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Write pending edits to XMP. `--all --mirror-tags --force --dry-run`
`--volume --asset`
`--mirror-tags` drops XMP entries the catalog doesn't have (requires `--all`).
`--force` rebuilds dc:subject + lr:hierarchicalSubject from catalog (more aggressive).

maki cleanup
Remove stale records. `--apply --list --volume --path`

maki dedup
Remove same-volume duplicate file locations. `--apply --prefer`

maki trash list / restore *PATH* **/ empty**
Files trashed by **delete --remove-files**. `--older-than DAYS --all`
`--dry-run`

maki generate-previews *[PATHS...]*
Generate/regenerate previews.
`--force --smart --upgrade`
`--volume --asset --include --skip`

maki relocate *[ASSET_IDS...]*
Copy/move files between volumes.
`--target VOLUME --query --remove-source`
`--create-sidecars --dry-run`

maki rebuild-catalog
Rebuild SQLite from YAML sidecars. `--asset ID` (per-asset)
Also: `migrate`, `create-sidecars`, `update-location`, `fix-roles`, `fix-dates`, `fix-recipes`

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Core Concepts

Asset	Logical media item (one photo)
Variant	Concrete file (Original, Alternate, Processed, Export)
Recipe	XMP/processing sidecar (tracked by location)
Volume	Storage device (online/offline detection)
Stack	Collapsed group in browse (own metadata)
Collection	Static album (manual curation)
Saved Search	Dynamic smart album (query re-evaluated)

Key Workflows

Import & Organize

1. `maki init` + `maki volume add`
2. `maki import --smart /path`
3. `maki serve` — browse in web UI
4. Rate, tag, label via UI or CLI
5. `maki auto-tag ""` [Pro]— AI tagging

Maintenance Cycle

1. `maki verify` — check integrity
2. `maki sync` — detect moved/missing
3. `maki sync-metadata` — bidirectional XMP [Pro]
4. `maki cleanup --apply` — remove stale

Backup & Archive

1. `maki volume add Archive /mnt/nas --purpose backup`
2. `maki relocate --target Archive ""` — copy all
3. `maki backup-status` — check coverage
4. `maki dedup --apply` — remove same-volume dups

Export & Deliver

1. `maki export "rating:4+ tag:portfolio" ./out`
2. `maki export "collection:Client" ./out --zip`
3. `maki contact-sheet "rating:5" portfolio.pdf`

Organize

`maki collection create / add / remove / list / show / delete`
Static albums. `create NAME`, `add NAME IDS...`, `remove NAME IDS...`

`maki saved-search save / list / run / delete`
Dynamic smart albums. `save NAME QUERY` `--sort --favorite`

`maki stack create` *`ASSET_IDS...`*
Create a stack. First = pick.

`maki stack add` *`REF ASSET_IDS...`*
Add assets to existing stack.

`maki stack remove / pick / dissolve / list / show`
Stack management commands.

`maki stack from-tag` *`PATTERN`*
Convert tag patterns to stacks. `--apply --remove-tags`

`maki faces detect / cluster / clean / name / merge / people`
[Pro]
Face detection and recognition (`download` fetches the models).
`--query --asset --apply --force --threshold --min-confidence`
Also: `faces status`, `faces export`, `faces similarity`, `faces dump-aligned`

Search Filter Syntax

All filters work in CLI `maki search` and web UI search box.

Text & Metadata

`tag:landscape`	Tag match (any level)
`tag:=` / `tag:/`	`=` whole path (exact value); `/` leaf only
`tag:^Landscape`	Case-sensitive (not "landscape")
`tag:|wed`	Prefix anchor (wedding, wedding-2024, ...)
`-tag:rejected`	Exclude tag
`type:image`	Asset type
`format:nef`	File format
`label:Red`	Color label
`camera:fuji`	Camera (partial)
`lens:56mm`	Lens (partial)
`description:cat`	Description (substring; alias `desc:`)
`person:Alice`	Named person (repeat for AND, comma for OR) [Pro]
`collection:Fav`	Collection
`path:2026/`	Path prefix (`*` = wildcard)
`id:72a0`	Asset ID prefix
`meta:key=val`	Source metadata

Numeric Filters

All support: `x` (exact), `x+` (min), `x-y` (range), `x,y` (OR)

`rating:3+`	3 stars or more
`rating:3-5`	3 to 5 stars
`rating:2,4`	Exactly 2 or 4
`rating:0`	Unrated ("the rest")
`iso:100-800`	ISO range
`focal:35-70`	Focal length range
`f:1.4-2.8`	Aperture range
`width:4000+`	Min width (px)
`height:2000+`	Min height (px)
`copies:2+`	File copies
`variants:2+`	Variant count
`scattered:2+`	Files spread across 2+ session roots
`duration:30+`	Video duration (seconds)
`codec:h264`	Video codec (partial)
`faces:2+`	Face count [Pro]

Date Filters

`date:2026`	Year prefix
`date:2026-03`	Month prefix
`date:2026-03-15`	Exact date
`dateFrom:2026-01`	From (inclusive)
`dateUntil:2026-12`	Until (inclusive)

Status Filters

`orphan:true`	No file locations
`orphan:false`	Has file locations
`missing:true`	Files missing on disk
`stale:30`	Not verified in N days
`stacked:true`	In a stack
`volume:Archive`	On specific volume
`volume:none`	No online volume
`geo:any`	Has GPS data

Pro Filters

`similar:72a0bb4b`	Visual similarity
`min_sim:90`	Similarity threshold
`text:sunset`	Text-to-image search
`embed:none`	No embedding

Combining Filters

`tag:a,b`	a OR b (comma)
`tag:a tag:b`	a AND b (repeat)
`-tag:x`	NOT (dash prefix)

Output Formats

`maki search --format` *`PRESET|TEMPLATE`*

`ids`	One UUID per line
`short`	ID, name, type, format, date
`full`	+ tags, description, rating
`json`	JSON array
`'{id}\t{name}'`	Custom template

Placeholders: `{id}`, `{short_id}`, `{name}`, `{filename}`, `{type}`, `{format}`, `{date}`, `{tags}`, `{description}`, `{hash}`, `{label}`

Configuration (maki.toml)

`[preview]`	max_edge, format, quality, smart_max_edge
`[serve]`	port, bind, per_page
`[import]`	exclude, auto_tags, smart_previews, profiles
`[browse]`	default_filter
`[cli]`	log, time, verbose (default global flags)
`[writeback]`	enabled (default: false) [Pro]
`[group]`	session_root_pattern (auto-group scope)
`[dedup]`	prefer
`[verify]`	max_age_days
`[ai]`	model, threshold, labels [Pro]
`[vlm]`	endpoint, model, timeout [Pro]
`[contact_sheet]`	layout, paper, fields

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https://maki-dam.com/